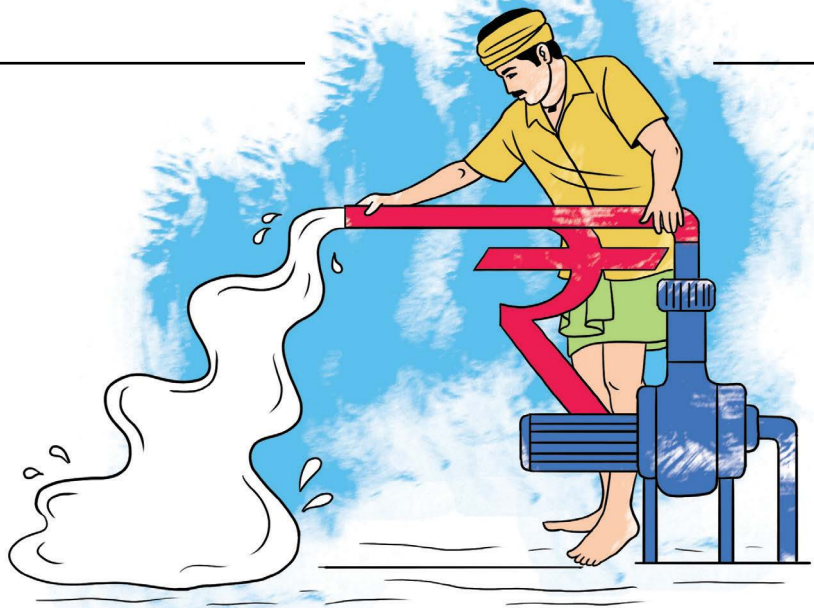


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FOCUS ON FOOD PROCESSING TO BOOST AGRI EXPORTS

► India can boost its agricultural and allied exports to \$70 billion from the current \$43 billion by focusing on value chains for items that have a potential to rise rapidly. Among various items, exports of rice, spices, fruits and vegetables have strong potential. India exported rice worth \$12 billion and spices worth \$4.5 billion in FY25. Private players' participation can ensure market orientation through value added products.



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ENHANCE AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTIVITY

► India's agricultural yield compares poorly with countries such as China. Besides climatic conditions, soil health, irrigation and use of fertilisers determine the farm output. India needs to step up investment in irrigation network to make its agriculture drought resistant. Greater adoption of high-yielding seeds, mechanisation and technology are also necessary. In addition, farmers must be encouraged to grow crops more appropriate for conditions in their region.

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PROMOTE NON-FARM ACTIVITY

► Non-farm activities such as fishing, dairying, poultry and beekeeping have the potential to provide employment in rural areas, diversify incomes and protect from economic risks due to crop failures. Supplementary income from these activities will help farm households improve their quality of life and give them surplus to invest in children's education, farm equipment and consumer goods.

SMOOTHEN FARM CREDIT FLOW

► Farmers need timely and adequate supply of credit for purchasing agricultural inputs such as seeds, fertilisers and pesticides, and to invest in assets such as machinery and godowns. While access to institutional credit has improved, dependence on high-cost non-institutional credit remains high. Streamlining processes for disbursing farm loans, improving financial literacy and tailoring products is the need of the hour.

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